

Paper 3: Conflict at Home and Abroad: the USA, 1954–75

"Why did domestic opposition force the USA to withdraw, and what was the consequence of the fall of Saigon?"

MASTERY PACK: KEY TOPIC 4: REACTIONS TO, AND THE END OF, US INVOLVEMENT IN THE VIETNAM WAR, 1964–75

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 80 Crucial Questions

Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app/units/usa/mastery_pack_KT4.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- 🟩 **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- 🟨 **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- 🟥 **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

- ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
- ⭐ ⭐ **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
- ⭐ **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

KT 4.1: Why did so many Americans oppose the Vietnam War (like at My Lai and Kent State)?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	What was the name of the system used to select young men for compulsory military service in Vietnam?	☐	☐	☐	
2	At which university did National Guardsmen shoot and kill four student protesters in May 1970?	☐	☐	☐	
3	Which student organization was at the forefront of the early anti-war protest movement?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What symbolic protest method involved young men burning their official government service notices?	☐	☐	☐	
5	Which heavyweight boxing champion famously refused to be drafted in 1967, citing religious beliefs?	☐	☐	☐	
6	What term describes the difference between what the government reported about the war and what journalists showed on TV?	☐	☐	☐	
7	In which South Vietnamese village did US troops massacre over 500 unarmed civilians in March 1968?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Who was the US Army lieutenant court-martialed and convicted of murder for ordering the My Lai massacre?	☐	☐	☐	
9	What was the name of the top-secret government history of the war leaked to the press in 1971?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which trusted CBS news anchor declared in 1968 that the war was mired in a stalemate?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What justification did Muhammad Ali give for refusing to fight in the Vietnam War?	☐	☐	☐	
12	What was the significance of the Kent State shootings in 1970?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
13	Why did the My Lai Massacre (1968) have such a devastating impact on the US homefront when it was revealed in 1969?	☐	☐	☐	
14	Who was the independent investigative journalist who broke the My Lai massacre story in November 1969?	☐	☐	☐	
15	Who was the military analyst who leaked the Pentagon Papers to newspapers in 1971?	☐	☐	☐	
16	What was the scale of the nationwide student strike triggered by the Kent State shootings in May 1970?	☐	☐	☐	
17	Which of the following best explains why the Tet Offensive was a turning point in the Vietnam War?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What was the most significant political consequence of the Tet Offensive on US domestic politics?	☐	☐	☐	
19	Which of the following was a primary cause of the growing 'credibility gap' between the US public and the government by 1971?	☐	☐	☐	
20	What was a major consequence of television news coverage of the Vietnam War, particularly after 1968?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

KT 4.2: Why did some Americans support the Vietnam War and the 'Silent Majority'?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	What term did Nixon use in November 1969 to describe the patriotic Americans who supported his war policy?	☐	☐	☐	
22	What was the primary political motivation for pro-war supporters in the US, fearing the global spread of communism?	☐	☐	☐	
23	What violent event occurred in New York City in May 1970 where construction workers attacked anti-war students?	☐	☐	☐	
24	What informal term was used to describe politicians and citizens who supported the escalation of the war?	☐	☐	☐	
25	What informal term was used to describe politicians and citizens who favored a peaceful exit from the war?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What popular pro-war slogan expressed the view that citizens who criticized the war should emigrate?	☐	☐	☐	
27	Which US president made the famous 'Silent Majority' speech on television in November 1969?	☐	☐	☐	
28	Which major national labor union coalition supported Nixon's war policy and helped organize the Hard Hat Riots?	☐	☐	☐	
29	What was the main purpose of President Nixon's 'Silent Majority' speech in 1969?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What pro-war student organization was formed to counter the radical anti-war Student Mobilization Committee?	☐	☐	☐	
31	How many construction workers marched in support of Nixon in	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	New York City in the days following the Hard Hat Riots?				
32	What concept of national duty and pride did working-class supporters frequently cite when criticizing student protesters?	☐	☐	☐	
33	Why did Nixon appeal specifically to the 'Silent Majority' in 1969?	☐	☐	☐	
34	What demographic groups formed the primary social base for Nixon's Silent Majority?	☐	☐	☐	
35	What did pro-war advocates fear would happen to US allies if the United States withdrew from Vietnam in defeat?	☐	☐	☐	
36	Approximately how many construction workers charged and attacked student anti-war protesters during the 1970 Hard Hat Riot?	☐	☐	☐	
37	Which of the following best explains why the revelation of the My Lai Massacre in 1969 deeply shocked the American public?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What was the primary consequence of the Kent State shootings in 1970?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Which of the following was a primary cause of the Hard Hat Riots in New York City in 1970?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Which of the following best describes the significance of Nixon's 'Silent Majority' strategy for his presidency?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT 4.3: How did the US exit Vietnam, and why did South Vietnam fall so quickly in 1975?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	What event marked the official end of the Vietnam War and the defeat of South Vietnam in 1975?	☐	☐	☐	
42	What was the name of the final North Vietnamese conventional offensive that captured Saigon in 1975?	☐	☐	☐	
43	What was the name of the US helicopter evacuation of Saigon in April 1975?	☐	☐	☐	
44	Who was the South Vietnamese President who surrendered Saigon to North Vietnamese forces?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Which US president was responsible for negotiating and signing the 1973 Paris Peace Accords?	☐	☐	☐	
46	How many days did the US have to withdraw all troops under the 1973 Accords?	☐	☐	☐	
47	Why did South Vietnamese President Thieu initially refuse to sign the accords?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What bombing campaign was ordered to force the signing of the accords in late 1972?	☐	☐	☐	
49	Which 1973 Act of Congress limited the president's power to commit troops to foreign conflicts without approval?	☐	☐	☐	
50	Which constitutional amendment lowered the US voting age to 18 in 1971, prompted by the draft?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What was the significance of the Fall of Saigon in 1975 for US foreign policy?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What prominent building in Saigon became the iconic site of helicopter evacuations during Operation Frequent Wind?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
53	Under the War Powers Act of 1973, within how many hours must a president notify Congress of troop deployment?	☐	☐	☐	
54	Why did the US Congress pass the War Powers Act in 1973?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Who was the chief North Vietnamese secret negotiator who met with Henry Kissinger in Paris?	☐	☐	☐	
56	Which June 1973 congressional amendment prohibited all further US military action in Indochina after 15 August 1973?	☐	☐	☐	
57	Which of the following best explains why the Paris Peace Accords of 1973 did not lead to a lasting peace in Vietnam?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What was the primary consequence of the Fall of Saigon in April 1975?	☐	☐	☐	
59	Which of the following was a primary cause for the US refusal to provide military aid or air support to South Vietnam during the 1975 North Vietnamese offensive?	☐	☐	☐	
60	Which of the following best describes the significance of the 1973 War Powers Act in relation to the executive presidency?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

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KT 4.4: What were the main reasons why the US failed to win the war in Vietnam?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	What was the name of the highly resilient supply route running through Laos and Cambodia that the US failed to block?	☐	☐	☐	
62	Which two communist superpowers provided essential military hardware, air defenses, and financial aid to North Vietnam?	☐	☐	☐	
63	What term was used to describe the collapse of morale behavior where US soldiers intentionally killed their own officers with grenades?	☐	☐	☐	
64	What US military strategy of attrition failed because the Vietcong were fighting a total war and could replace losses indefinitely?	☐	☐	☐	
65	What was a major cause of low morale and drug abuse among US troops, who were mostly young, working-class conscripts?	☐	☐	☐	
66	What chemical weapons and defoliants dropped by the US ruined its global reputation and alienated South Vietnamese peasants?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Which 1968 offensive, though a military defeat for the Vietcong, was a political victory that shattered US support?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What did the US Congress cut in 1974 that severely weakened the South Vietnamese military prior to the final invasion?	☐	☐	☐	
69	What term describes the psychological reluctance of the US public and politicians to intervene militarily abroad after Vietnam?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What was the primary economic consequence of the war's high	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
	military expenditure on the US homefront?				
71	Which superpower provided North Vietnam with advanced anti-aircraft missiles and radar (referred to in the syllabus as Russian support)?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What strategic military miscalculation by General Westmoreland underestimated the motivation of the communist forces?	☐	☐	☐	
73	How did the one-year tour of duty system affect the combat effectiveness and morale of the US military?	☐	☐	☐	
74	What major weakness of the South Vietnamese military (ARVN) contributed to the ultimate US failure in Vietnam?	☐	☐	☐	
75	Why was the South Vietnamese (Saigon) government unable to win the 'hearts and minds' of its own people?	☐	☐	☐	
76	What was the average age of a US combat soldier in Vietnam, which contributed to low morale and inexperience?	☐	☐	☐	
77	Which of the following is the most significant reason why US military power failed to defeat the Vietcong?	☐	☐	☐	
78	What was the primary consequence of the War Powers Act passed by Congress in 1973?	☐	☐	☐	
79	Which of the following best explains why the South Vietnamese government (ARVN and political regime) failed to win the support of its own population?	☐	☐	☐	
80	How did the US military draft system act as a major factor in the failure of the US war effort?	☐	☐	☐	

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THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

KT 4.1: Why did so many Americans oppose the Vietnam War (like at My Lai and Kent State)?

1. The Draft
2. Kent State University
3. Students for a Democratic Society (SDS)
4. Draft card burning
5. Muhammad Ali
6. Credibility gap
7. My Lai
8. William Calley
9. The Pentagon Papers
10. Walter Cronkite
11. His religious beliefs and opposition to fighting other people of color
12. They triggered a nationwide student strike and highlighted deep divisions over the war
13. It exposed the moral cost of the war and shocked the public's conscience
14. Seymour Hersh
15. Daniel Ellsberg
16. Over 2 million students strike across 400 campuses
17. It shattered US government claims that the enemy was near defeat, widening the 'credibility gap.'
18. It led President Johnson to halt bombing, begin peace talks, and announce he would not run for re-election.
19. The publication of the Pentagon Papers and the exposure of the My Lai Massacre.
20. It brought the brutal reality of combat into American living rooms, turning public opinion against the war.

KT 4.2: Why did some Americans support the Vietnam War and the 'Silent Majority'?

21. The Silent Majority
22. Anti-communism
23. Hard Hat Riots
24. Hawks
25. Doves
26. America: Love It or Leave It
27. Richard Nixon

KT 4.2: Why did some Americans support the Vietnam War and the 'Silent Majority'?

28. AFL-CIO
29. To appeal to moderate Americans for support for his Vietnamisation policy against anti-war protestors
30. Young Americans for Freedom (YAF)
31. Over 20,000
32. Patriotism
33. To bypass active anti-war protesters and show Congress he had broad public support
34. Working-class, suburban, and older conservative Americans
35. Loss of US global credibility and containment failure
36. 200 workers
37. It exposed the brutal killing of unarmed Vietnamese civilians by US soldiers and a subsequent military cover-up.
38. It intensified the student anti-war movement, leading to a national student strike of over 4 million students.
39. Working-class anger at student anti-war protestors who were seen as unpatriotic and privileged.
40. It allowed Nixon to isolate the anti-war movement and build a powerful electoral coalition for the 1972 election.



KT 4.3: How did the US exit Vietnam, and why did South Vietnam fall so quickly in 1975?

41. The Fall of Saigon to North Vietnamese forces
42. The Ho Chi Minh Campaign
43. Operation Frequent Wind
44. Duong Van Minh
45. Richard Nixon
46. 60 days
47. North Vietnamese troops stayed in the South
48. Operation Linebacker II (Christmas Bombings)
49. War Powers Act
50. 26th Amendment
51. It marked the ultimate failure of the US containment policy in Vietnam
52. US Embassy roof
53. 48 hours
54. To limit the president's ability to wage undeclared war without congressional approval

KT 4.3: How did the US exit Vietnam, and why did South Vietnam fall so quickly in 1975?

55. Le Duc Tho
56. Case-Church Amendment
57. The agreement allowed North Vietnamese troops to remain in the South, leading to renewed conflict once US forces left.
58. The total defeat of South Vietnam, the evacuation of US personnel, and the unification of Vietnam under a communist government.
59. Congress had passed the Case-Church Amendment and cut military funding, blocking further intervention.
60. It represented a direct reassertion of Congressional authority to limit the President's unilateral control over war-making.

KT 4.4: What were the main reasons why the US failed to win the war in Vietnam?



61. Ho Chi Minh Trail
62. Soviet Union and China
63. Fragging
64. Search and Destroy
65. The Draft
66. Agent Orange and Napalm
67. Tet Offensive
68. Military funding
69. Vietnam Syndrome
70. High inflation and deficits
71. Soviet Union
72. Strategy of attrition
73. Prevented experience build-up and lowered unit cohesion
74. High desertion rates, corruption, and heavy reliance on US air support
75. Extreme political corruption, religious bias, and reliance on US force
76. 19 years old
77. The Vietcong's effective guerrilla tactics, local knowledge, and determination outlasted the US political will to fight.
78. It restricted the President's power to commit US troops to foreign conflicts without congressional approval.
79. It was plagued by corruption, failed to implement land reform, and was seen as a puppet of the United States.
80. It created an army of reluctant, inexperienced conscripts and fueled massive anti-war protests at home.

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 80 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/80)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

1. My ultimate strength in this unit is...

2. The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...

3. Key targets and action steps for the next retrieval attempt: